

Unit 2 Education



本单元主要讨论与教育相关的话题

Part 1 Words in Context

Passage 2: Teenage Children U2-2

Nearly all the parents of teenagers could have the same **nightmare: teenager** problem. No matter how hard you **choose** to deal with it, at **certain** times, the once wonderful, reasonable and helpful child will turn into a terrible one. Some parents may **blame** themselves because there is not a lot they can do about it. They feel hopeless at these particular moments.



But where do the conflicts come from? Let me give you an example. One strict mother **insisted** from the time her son could speak that he should stand up whenever a guest enter the room, open doors, shake hands with the guest and say **goodbye** when the guest leaves their house, like what a **gentleman** should do. However, when I visited them last week, I saw the boy sprawling (伸展) himself on the sofa, made no **attempt** to turn off the TV or lower the **volume** as I walked in, and his greeting was no more than a quick **glance**. His mother felt **ashamed**. "I don't know what to do with him these days," the mother felt sorry and said. "He's **forgotten** all the **manners** we taught him."



But has he really **forgotten** them? I doubt. Maybe he has just decided that he's not going to use them. She said that sometimes she wished that she could throw him down from the sofa onto the floor.

One more example for you: another good friend of mine couldn't stand her two daughters climbing all over

the **furniture**, reaching across the table, **staring** at me and saying **loudly**, "I don't like your dress. It's ugly." My poor friend tried everything she could in vain. Now one of the daughters has recently been driven out of school. The other has left home. That's too bad.

"Where did we go wrong?" Those parents are very sad now. Probably **nowhere**, in my opinion. The only thing that goes wrong can be the lack of understanding between parents and children. Listen to them and talk to them like friends. Maybe we can understand them better.